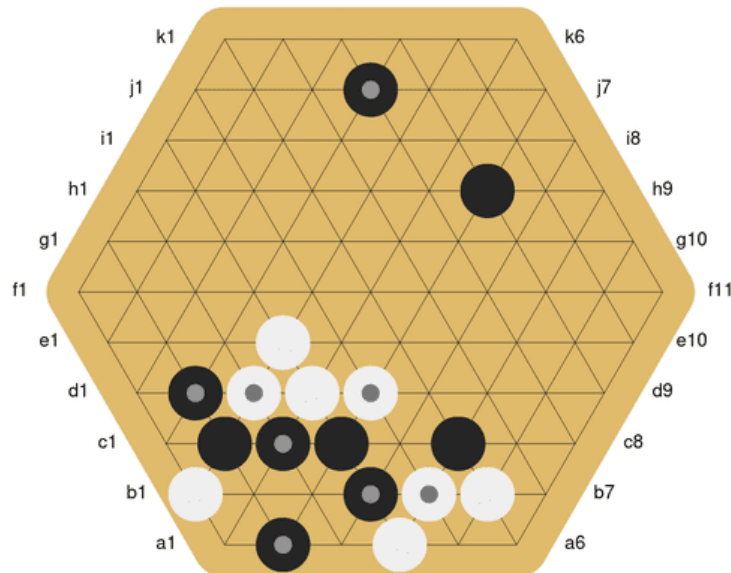


Oonpia

2026, Hoembla, <https://boardgamegeek.com/thread/3251219>

The game is played on a hexhex6, initially empty. Each player has two types of pieces.



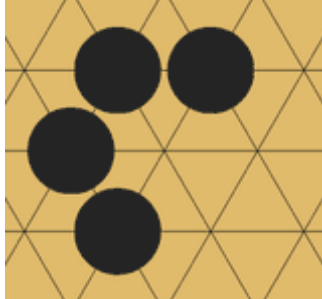
Fighting over a corner. Can black save his lone dotted stone?

Definitions

- Two adjacent stones are **connected** if they have the opposite type.
- A **group** consists of all the stones of a single colour reachable through steps through *connected* stones.
- A **liberty** of a stone is an empty site adjacent to that stone, such that a connected stone could be placed there without violating the *placement restriction* (but not considering captures, ko etc...).
- The player's **territories** are those contiguous areas of empty sites that are connected by at least one liberty to your stones, and by no liberties to enemy stones. (This means that some enemy stones can be adjacent to your territory, if they don't have a liberty pointing inside the territory.)

Rules

- The game uses Go rules, except:
- No chain of four adjacent stones of the same type, regardless of colour, may be formed on the sites surrounding any single site.

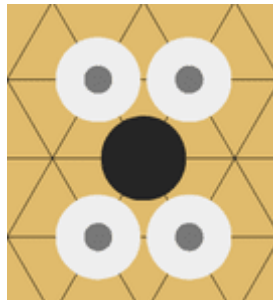


don't make this shape, or its rotations, with stones of one type

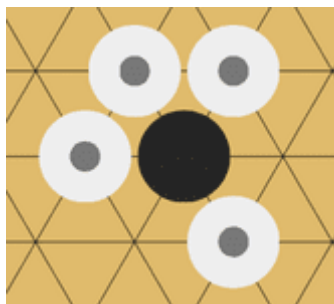
- Killing your own stones is only allowed if they are in a different group than the placed stone (these are scored as if captured by the opponent).
- Wins the player with the most territory + captured enemy stones.

Some tactical situations:

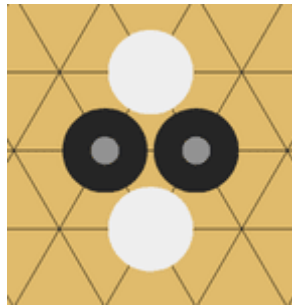
Like in go, a lone stone can be captured by 4 stones, either like this:



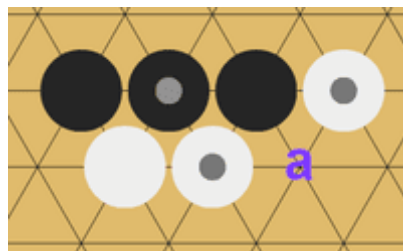
or like this:



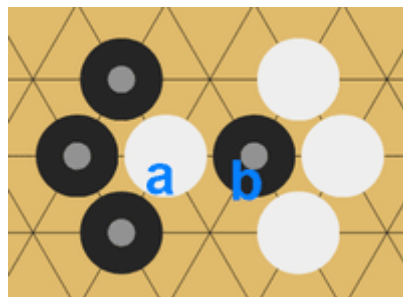
The basic crosscut:



A [hane](#), which could lead naturally to a crosscut by black, since placing a connected black stone at 'a' would create a group of 4 dotted stones and is therefore not allowed:



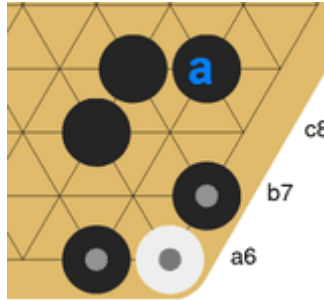
One of the possible [ko](#) situations (white 'a' captures black 'b', black could capture white after playing elsewhere):



A [ladder](#), only the bottom row of pieces is present at first, after which black 'a' starts the ladder:



Distant capture: The placement restriction can be used to capture stones/groups from a distance by removing their last liberty (black 'a' captures the white stone):



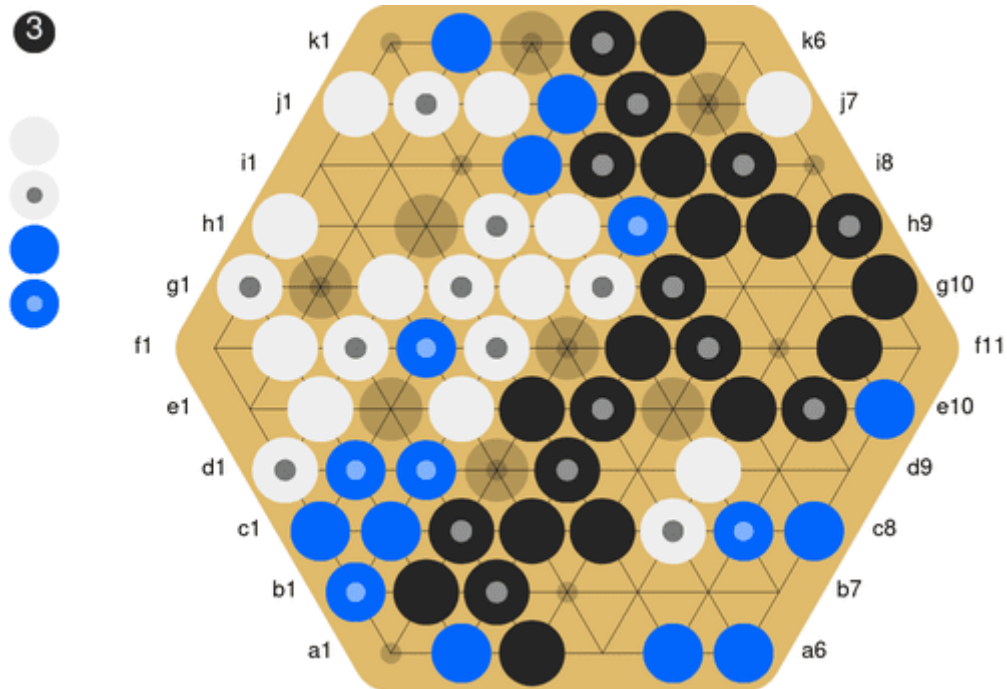
I think this game has some nice properties for a hexagonal go variant (if you can still call it a go variant). It has many go-like structures and tactics as shown above (some may recall my earlier and much clunkier [attempt](#) to have ladders emerge in a hex go). Unlike [Blooms](#), [TriGo](#) or [HexSyGo](#), there is a single placement per turn. Unlike [Keil](#) or [Lozengo](#), the connectivity between stones already on the board is not changed by other stones placed in the neighbourhood (though I actually do also really like that feature 😊). Of course this comes at the cost of two types of stones with a special connectivity rule and a placement restriction, which does however give the game its own flavour.

It strikes me there are still some loose ends here. Some cells may become completely unplayable (when they are blocked for both dotted and undotted stones), should these count towards your territory or not? How to deal with cycles? Is it allowed to kill your own groups (for example with the distance capture) and why/why not? I'm tempted to cut through all these issues by adopting Luis' [Bluestone](#) (the [Redstone](#) variant, not the recent connection game), with [prison downsizing](#), as a superstructure for this game. That means there are permanent blue stones that will be used in any capturing move. The blue stones also come in two types and are subject to the no-4-arc rule. Self-capture is allowed.

On another note, I haven't really explained why I think this game, as a hexagonal territorial game (maybe "go variant" is a bit of a stretch at this point), is worth caring about at all, despite its somewhat byzantine complexity. It was the result of a quest to find a hexagonal game where go-like ladders naturally emerge. But the reason I went looking for such a game is not because I think the ladder itself is such an essential element of go tactics, but because I feel the presence of ladders shows that the game is balanced just on that knife edge between chaos and structure that makes go so deep and fun.

Stones can be just on the edge between captured and living, and which side they ultimately fall on depends on stones totally at the other side of the board. I'm quite

convinced any good hexagonal go-like will have something like that. Well, we know this is true for go, it's only a heuristic guess for Oonpia. Much the same goes for the presence of crosscuts, though hexagonal games with crosscuts are a bit easier to come by.



Example endgame - 3 black stones in the prison, white resigns:

The blue stone version [is playable on abstractplay.org](https://abstractplay.org).

[BGG description]